As for Daniyal, reports kept arriving from the Deccan confirming his increasing dependence on alcohol and deteriorating health. Akbar sent Hakim Fath Ullah, son of Hakim Abu'l Fath, to tend to the prince. He then sent him a horse named Ayas and, finally, when physicians and gifts failed to work, sent an old milk mother from his childhood to try and turn things around. An idealized miniature of Daniyal from this period shows a tall, broad-shouldered, fair-complexioned young man with features reminiscent of his father's Turkic legacy. Salim, too, would later admit that Daniyal 'was a young man of fine stature, with a pleasing build and good-looking'.

After Salim had returned to Allahabad his penitential attitude towards his father, and his seeming remorse over the murder of Abu'l Fazl seemed to have evaporated. He ignored his father's summons to return to Agra and pay obeisance to the Padshah. Instead, he continued to posture as an independent monarch. Akbar decided that the time for open confrontation with his son had finally arrived. In August 1604 he sailed down the river at the head of a fleet of boats while his imperial gold-embroidered tents were pitched near Fatehpur Sikri. However, no sooner had the boats sailed off down the river than they got bogged down in the loamy sand due to the low water levels. As Akbar disembarked and waited in the royal tents, news arrived that Hamida Banu was critically ill. Akbar thought that this was a diversionary tactic, since Hamida Banu had been very disapproving of Akbar setting off to fight the prince. He sent Khurram to assess the truth behind this illness but 'heart-striking news came… that she was seriously ill and that the physicians had given up issuing medicines'. By the time Akbar rushed back to the capital, Hamida Banu was unconscious. She had asked to see her own imperial copy of the Ramayan upon her deathbed one last time. Scholars believe she may have had a particular affinity for the trials of Sita because of her own long-ago period of exile in Rajasthan, and then Persia, when she had had to abandon her infant son. Hamida Banu died on 29 August 1604, leaving behind considerable treasure in her house.

Mughal noblewomen were becoming increasingly wealthy, as the empire itself became a colossus. Unlike most of their contemporaries in the west, as well as other Hindustani women, Mughal women owned their property and wealth outright, and could spend it according to their wishes and ambitions. They were given a monthly stipend, in addition to annual gifts upon different occasions, such as birthdays, Nauroz, military victories, and could further grow their wealth by investing in trade, or through